

MORE MUSCLE. SAME AWARENESS.

Protein, timing, and the Common Follies that quietly stall progress.

Building muscle is not complicated. It is often made complicated. The body responds to enough high-quality protein, enough total energy, progressive training, and sleep. Everything else is secondary. This sheet gives you the few levers that matter and names the mistakes that waste the most time.

PROTEIN TARGET

1.4-1.6 g per kg bodyweight

Start at **1.4 g** per kilogram of your bodyweight. If recovery and progress feel slow after two to three weeks of consistent training, move toward **1.6 g**. That range is enough for most people who are training with intention.

Example: 80 kg person → roughly 112–128 g protein per day.

Supported by resistance-training meta-analyses that show diminishing returns beyond ~1.6 g/kg for most trainees.

CIRCADIAN TIMING

Insulin sensitivity and glucose handling are generally better earlier in the waking day than late in the evening for most people. A solid protein-containing meal earlier in the day therefore tends to be used more efficiently.

Practical cue: include a meaningful protein source in the first real meal after you rise. Total daily protein still matters most. Timing is a useful secondary lever, not a rigid rule.

× COMMON FOLLY – THREE TRAPS THAT STALL MUSCLE

- ✗ **Chasing 2 g+ per kg by default.** Higher intakes are sometimes useful in a hard deficit or for advanced trainees. For most people they add food volume and complication without proportional return. Protein the body does not use for tissue or energy is not stored as extra muscle — the surplus energy can contribute to body fat like any other surplus. 1.4–1.6 g done consistently beats higher numbers done sporadically.
- ✗ **Under-eating while trying to grow.** Muscle is built more readily in a slight energy surplus than in a deficit. If strength is stalled, recovery feels poor, and you are “eating clean” but still tired, you may simply not be eating enough total food.
- ✗ **Over-complication.** Elaborate rotation, constant tracking, and twelve-ingredient preparations are not required. A few high-quality protein sources, repeated, with enough energy around training, will outperform a complex plan you cannot sustain.

PRACTICAL LEVERS

Eggs. Whole eggs (yolk included) remain one of the highest biological-value proteins available. Adding two to four eggs to an existing meal is often the simplest way to raise daily protein without inventing a new diet.

One other anchor. Choose a second reliable source you actually like — meat, fish, dairy, or legumes — and make sure it appears most days.

Total energy. If you are training and not gaining, eat a little more of the foods you already tolerate. Awareness first, restriction second.

SIMPLE DAILY PATTERN

Not a menu — a shape:

1. First real meal: include a clear protein source (eggs work well here).
2. Around training: enough food that you can perform and recover.
3. Rest of the day: ordinary meals that already contain protein, adjusted upward if the daily total is low.

You are looking for consistency across weeks, not perfection across hours.

BITE IT – WRITE IT

For two weeks, keep a simple food journal. Write what you actually ate, not what you meant to eat. No moral commentary. At the end of each day note roughly how much protein you think you got and how the body felt in training and recovery. Patterns become obvious once they are on paper. Most people discover they were either lower on protein than they believed, or lower on total energy. Both are fixable once seen.